Instagram colour guide

Three colour directions for Kelpcrete, Reading Room, the building and events. No palette has been selected. Choose one complete direction before finalising the templates.

01 Electric

Kelpcrete	Reading Room	Building	Events	Neutral
#FF5F00	#00A99D	#2B2C7C	#101113	#F5F3EB

02 Refined

Kelpcrete	Reading Room	Building	Events	Neutral
#FF6A00	#007674	#2B2C7C	#17191B	#F5F0E6

03 After dark

Kelpcrete	Reading Room	Building	Events	Neutral
#FF5A00	#30D5C8	#2B2C7C	#090C10	#F1F5F1

Recommended starting point

Option 02 Refined is the provisional recommendation. Its deeper teal gives Reading Room a quieter tone beside the bright Kelpcrete orange and the shared ultramarine. The warm neutral allows photographs and longer text to breathe. This is a design recommendation, subject to your choice.

01 Electric

Punchier teal and a clean, warm neutral. A lively, high-energy direction.

02 Refined

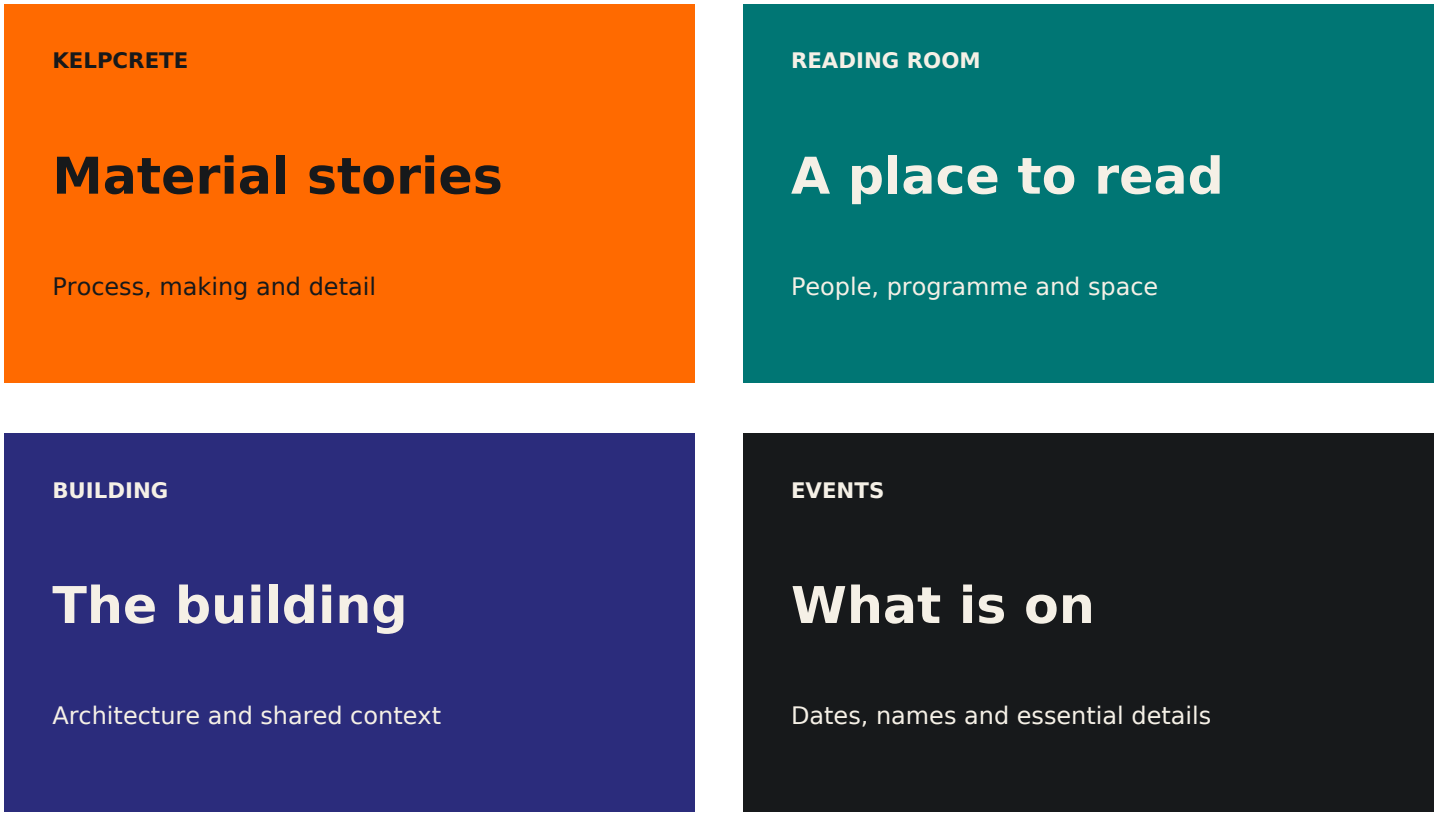
Deeper teal, warm paper and softened black. A balanced, editorial direction.

03 After dark

Luminous teal, near-black and a cooler neutral. A sharper, nightlife-led direction.

One system with clear roles

Refined is shown below only to demonstrate the system. Keep the same layout and type hierarchy across all categories, then let the category colour identify the subject.



Illustrative sample copy and layout, not finished posts.

Use colour with restraint

Lead with one category colour. Use the neutral for supporting slides, longer captions and breathing room. Keep the other category colours out of the same layout unless the post genuinely covers more than one strand.

Keep typography consistent. Use a clear sans serif, strong headline contrast and a simple headline / supporting text / detail hierarchy. Use regular or medium weights for small text; avoid thin type and long all-cap passages.

Do not rely on colour alone. Keep the category name visible. Review the export at its actual phone size, including small dates and venue details, and check every text-over-photo treatment separately.

Production and legibility

These HEX values are proposed digital colours. The screen study is a starting point for testing, not a paint, ink or print specification.

Check the existing colours first

Reading Room teal: verify the exact existing brand colour from the original artwork or brand specification before locking any option. The three teal values here are proposals, not verified matches.

Building blue: RAL 5002 Ultramarine blue is the physical reference. #2B2C7C is a screen approximation, not an exact cross-media match. Confirm paint against a current physical RAL sample.

Kelpcrete orange: physical fluorescent colour cannot be represented faithfully by a HEX value or ordinary CMYK print. If a fluorescent finish is intended, approve a real material or spot-ink sample with the supplier.

Text pairings to use

For Refined, these solid-colour pairings exceed 4.5:1. Values below are calculated from the proposed sRGB HEX colours and rounded for display.

Aa	**Kelpcrete orange**	#17191B on #FF6A00	**6.14:1**
Aa	**Reading Room teal**	#F5F0E6 on #007674	**4.81:1**
Aa	**Building ultramarine**	#F5F0E6 on #2B2C7C	**10.54:1**
Aa	**Events near-black**	#F5F0E6 on #17191B	**15.52:1**

Avoid white text on orange or light teal. Use dark text on all three oranges and on the brighter Electric and After dark teals. Aim for at least 4.5:1 for ordinary text; W3C permits 3:1 for large text. Check final rendered size rather than the design-file point size.

Approval and references

Before release: choose 01, 02 or 03; verify the Reading Room source teal; approve final digital samples and any physical colour proofs; then save one shared set of colour styles.

Josef Albers, Interaction of Color, Yale University Press: inspiration for testing how colour changes in context, not a prescribed palette. Legibility reference: W3C WCAG 2.2 contrast guidance.